

## ***M1 I Reflective Essay***

One of the most influential people in my life who inspired me to take my current course is my *Kuya*. When we were younger and living in Balibago, I often accompanied him to computer shops, where I discovered video games. What started as simple enjoyment slowly turned into curiosity about how computers worked, which eventually led me to pursue a course related to technology. As a teen entering her twenties, the value that I take from Eastern perspectives on the self, particularly the Confucian principle of considering others before oneself. His respectful way of treating people and his sense of responsibility shaped how I interact with others. I see this reflected in my own belief of “*Don’t do unto others what you don’t want done unto you*” showing how relational and moral values continue to guide my choices.

As I grew older, I also developed traits influenced by Western perspectives, especially the idea of independence and individualism. I enjoy doing things on my own, making my own decisions, and being responsible for my personal growth. This habit reflects the Western view of the self as independent and self-directed. While Eastern culture emphasizes family and community, my preference for independence sometimes puts me in between these two perspectives. There are moments when I struggle to balance being self-reliant while still valuing close family ties, but this combination ultimately shapes my identity. It allows me to value personal freedom without losing respect for relationships and shared responsibilities.

These blended perspectives became more evident when I traveled to Singapore and experienced cultural differences firsthand. I noticed how discipline, efficiency, and respect for rules were deeply embedded in everyday life, which felt different from what I was used to in the Philippines. Instead of resisting these differences, I observed and learned from them. As a BSIT student, these experiences are valuable because working or migrating abroad is common in my field. Understanding different cultures helps me adapt more easily and work better with diverse teams. In the future, I can promote cultural empathy by being open-minded, respectful of different practices, and considerate when collaborating with people from various backgrounds, especially in global or multicultural work environments.